

EQUAL OPPORTUNITY FOR EQUITABLE, SAFE AND INCLUSIVE ENVIRONMENT

The Loudoun County School Board is committed to providing for an equitable, safe, and inclusive learning and working environment. Loudoun County Public Schools believes all students, staff, the division, and community members deserve rigorous and respectful learning and working environments. This policy demonstrates our commitment to serve the entire LCPS community and to ensure safe, welcoming, and responsive school and work environments. It clarifies the expectation of LCPS to ensure an equitable, safe, and inclusive environment that provides access to services, spaces, opportunities, and accommodations to meet the disparate needs of our LCPS community.

The School Board affirms a commitment to this principle for all persons regardless of perceived or actual race, color, religion, ethnic or national origin, citizenship or immigration status, sex, pregnancy, childbirth or related medical conditions, age, marital status, sexual orientation, gender identity, gender expression, socioeconomic level, military status, or disability.

It is the intent of the School Board that every policy shall reflect this commitment, and in partnership with district leadership every practice and procedure is equally aligned to our affirmations. Behavior that is not unlawful may nevertheless be unacceptable for the educational environment or the workplace. Mistreatment, bullying harassment, and otherwise harmful actions are prohibited, particularly if directed at the personal characteristics listed above. The School Board and LCPS acknowledge inequity on the individual level, such as biased speech and harassment, and injustice at the institutional or systemic level, such as discrimination, have a harmful impact on the community, historically and today.

The School Board believes it is the shared responsibility of the School Board, students, staff, Division, and community members to work towards educational equity. The unique characteristics of our students and staff are valued as strengths that contribute to the overall school community. We believe that all students can succeed, and all students, staff, families, and community members possess valuable perspectives and experiences that strengthen our community.

This policy codifies the School Board's commitment to education equity and to look intentionally, comprehensively, and systematically at barriers and resource allocations which may be creating disparate experiences regarding access and opportunity. This makes the School Board's commitment more stable and sustainable for the future. This policy is intended to be a dynamic document responsive to present and future needs relative to the goal of maintaining an equitable environment for all students, staff, the Division, and the community it serves. To that end, the Superintendent is authorized to develop implementing regulations and school

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procedures to operationalize this policy.

[Former Policy 3-1]

Adopted: 6/8/76

Revised: 6/22/93, 4/13/11, 2/26/19, 1/14/21

Current Revision: 02/13/25

Leg Refs.: Code of Virginia, 1950, as amended, [§ 2.2-3900](#); [§ 2.2-3902](#), [§ 2.2-3904](#), [§ 2.2-3905](#), [§ 22.1-23.3](#), [42 U.S.C. § 12102\(1\), 12102\(3\)\(A\)](#); [28 C.F.R. § 35.108](#); [34 C.F.R. § 104.3\(j\)](#), [§ 22.1-208.02](#)

Cross Refs: Policy [1020](#), Strategic Framework; Policy [7014](#), Environments Free From Harassment, Discrimination, and Abuse; Policy [8210](#), Introduction to Student Discipline